

Selective note taking

Component 1 • Exercise 3 • 7 marks | syllabus 2027-2029

Learning focus

Locate relevant details under the given headings and write brief notes without repeating a point.

Read headings as questions

Each heading defines a purpose. Match evidence to that purpose and write the shortest clear phrase; full sentences are unnecessary. A number is useful only if it answers the heading. Distinguish “what happens” from “why it matters”.

Worked example

Under “activities”, “monthly story reading” is a clear note; “there are books” repeats the service description.

Check distinctness and accuracy

Use each answer line for a different point and avoid copying unrelated facts. If a challenge asks for two examples, road closure and funding costs count separately. The note must preserve the meaning and not reverse a condition.

Worked example

“Two drivers already work daily” would be wrong: a second driver is still being trained, and the present driver is available only two days a week.

Practice paper

Selective note taking

Original FagusED practice. Answer on the lines provided. The number of marks is shown in square brackets.

Name: _____ Date: _____

Reading text • about 400-500 words

The first year of a reading bus

In the hill towns north of Belford, some families live more than an hour from the nearest public library. Last April, a small group of teachers and volunteers turned an old bus into a travelling collection of books. They removed several seats and installed low shelves, leaving enough space for visitors to walk safely. The bus visits four villages, stopping in each place every second week.

Before the service began, volunteers asked residents which books they wanted. Young children requested picture books; teenagers suggested comics and books about science; many adults asked for practical guides and novels. The first collection included material for all three groups. Borrowing is free, but visitors write their name and a contact number so books can be returned at a later stop. No internet connection is needed on the bus.

The bus also offers activities. On the first Friday of each month, a volunteer reads aloud to younger children. During school holidays, local students lead a short writing workshop. Parents say that these events give families a reason to meet, especially in villages without a community hall. The volunteers enjoy learning readers' interests and recommending different titles.

There have been difficulties. In winter, heavy rain closed the narrow road to the smallest village twice. The team arranged a temporary collection point at a nearby shop, but some readers could not get there. New shelves cost more than expected, and repairs to the bus used most of the first donation. Since then, a local business has paid for replacement tyres, while residents have given books in good condition.

The organisers are careful about expansion. A fifth village has asked for a stop, yet the current driver is available only two days a week. Adding another place immediately might make all visits less reliable. The team is training a second driver and checking whether volunteers can continue to sort and record books every weekend.

After twelve months, the bus has over 300 registered users. The figure pleases the teachers, but they are more interested in what readers do with the service. One young visitor now borrows a new book every fortnight and recommends stories to her friends. For the organisers, that small habit is a sign that the bus is becoming part of everyday life.

For the next year, the volunteers hope to add books in several languages spoken by local families. They have asked readers for suggestions before purchasing anything. A young volunteer is also designing a clearer timetable for bus stops, with large print and simple symbols. Organisers believe these changes will help new visitors understand the service without adding another village before the driver and the budget are ready.

Read the article and complete the notes below. Write one clear detail on each numbered line.

1. One type of book requested by teenagers: **[1]**

2. One detail visitors give to borrow a book: **[1]**

3. An activity offered to younger children: **[1]**

4. One reason families value the events: [1]

5. One weather-related difficulty: [1]

6. One way the project received support after repair costs: [1]

7. A practical reason the fifth village has not been added yet: [1]

Answers and explanations

1. comics / books about science [1]. A brief phrase under the appropriate heading is sufficient.
2. name / contact number [1]. A brief phrase under the appropriate heading is sufficient.
3. monthly reading aloud / story reading [1]. A brief phrase under the appropriate heading is sufficient.
4. they provide a reason to meet / villages lack a community hall [1]. A brief phrase under the appropriate heading is sufficient.
5. heavy rain closed the road to the smallest village [1]. A brief phrase under the appropriate heading is sufficient.
6. local business paid for replacement tyres / residents gave books [1]. A brief phrase under the appropriate heading is sufficient.
7. driver available only two days a week / second driver still in training [1]. A brief phrase under the appropriate heading is sufficient.

Checking your work

Read the question again after finding the evidence. Do not add a second, conflicting answer. For multi-point questions, count distinct details.

Assessment structure: Cambridge IGCSE English as a Second Language (Count-in Speaking) 0511 syllabus for 2027–2029, <https://www.cambridgeinternational.org/Images/721343-2027-2029-syllabus.pdf>. Original passages, prompts and scripts by FagusED. June 2026 papers and mark schemes supplied by the user informed presentation. Independent practice material, not an official Cambridge paper.